

Lesson 47: Jesus Christ—Our Savior, Lord and King

Purpose: To strengthen our testimonies of Jesus Christ and our love for Him, to draw us nearer to Him this Christmas season.

†1. Alfred Edersheim

†2. Elder Bruce D. Porter

†3. Elder Bruce D. Porter

†4. Elder Bruce D. Porter

†5. Elder Bruce D. Porter

1. Christ's coming was foretold.

Scriptural Prophecies of Christ: (See *Topical Guide: Jesus Christ—Prophecies About*, p. 252)

- [Isaiah 7:14](#). "Behold, a virgin shall conceive, and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel." Heb.: "El is with us"
- [Matthew 1:18-23](#). "When as his mother Mary was espoused to Joseph, before they came together, she was found with child of the Holy Ghost..." The angel said, "they shall call his name Emmanuel, which ... interpreted is, God with us."
- [Micah 5:2](#). "But thou, Bethlehem ... yet out of thee shall he come forth unto me that is to be a ruler in Israel ..."
- [Matthew 1:2](#); [Luke 2:4](#). "And Joseph also went ... unto the city of David, which is called Bethlehem".
- [Zechariah 9:9](#). "behold, thy King cometh unto thee ... riding upon an ass, and upon a colt the foal of an ass."
- [Mark 11:7](#). "And they brought the colt to Jesus, and cast their garments on him; and he sat upon him."
- [Psalm 22:16](#). "they pierced my hands and my feet."
- [John 20:25-27](#). "Then saith he to Thomas, Reach hither thy finger, and behold my hands".
- [Psalm 69:21](#). "They gave me ... vinegar to drink."
- [John 19:28-30](#). "and they filled a sponge with vinegar, ... and put it to his mouth."
- [Malachi 3:1](#). The "Lord, whom ye seek, shall suddenly come to his temple". ["This is important because the temple was destroyed in A.D. 70 and was never rebuilt." See "[10 Prophecies About Jesus' Birth](#)"]
- [Luke 2:25-32](#). Simeon in the temple took the Christ child in his arms and said, "For mine eyes have seen thy salvation".
- [Isaiah 53:1-12](#). When "thou shalt make his soul an offering for sin".

2. Christ's coming was foreshadowed and typified.

Testimony and covenant of the Old Testament:

- a. Abraham offering Isaac as a sacrifice—a similitude of Christ ([Jacob 4:5](#)).
- b. Joseph who was sold into Egypt—a type of Christ
- c. Moses—"a similitude or living symbol of Jesus Christ" (see [Moses 1:6](#)).
- d. The Passover—saved by the blood of the paschal lamb, firstborn, without blemish
- e. Law of Moses—each animal sacrifice, firstborn, without blemish—was symbolic of Christ's sacrifice ([Moses 5:6-7](#)).

Testimony and covenant of The Book of Mormon:

- Nephi—[2 Nephi 11:4](#); Amulek—[Alma 34:14](#); King Benjamin—[Mosiah 3:14-15](#); Abinadi—[Mosiah 13:29-31](#).

3. Christ's coming was and is fulfilled.

Testimony and covenant of the New Testament

Testimony and covenant of the Restoration:

- Joseph Smith's First Vision: [Joseph Smith—History 1:15-20](#)
- Joseph Smith and Sidney Rigdon: [D&C 76:22-24](#)
- Joseph Smith and Oliver Cowdery: [D&C 110:1-5](#)

4. Renewing our adoration for Him this Christmas season.

- [Alma 5:26](#). If "ye have felt to sing the song of redeeming love, I would ask, can ye feel so now?"

What are your favorite scriptural verses from or about Christ?

What are your feelings for Christ? †6. President Dieter F. Uchtdorf

†7. President Dieter F. Uchtdorf

Next Week: A review of the Doctrine and Covenants and Church History. [Class Member Study Guide](#).

For the first week in the year 2014 see Old Testament: Click on [Lesson 1](#): "This Is My Work and My Glory."

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Old Testament Manual: Religion 301 and 302](#).) † •

†1. **Alfred Edersheim:** “Properly understood, the Scripture is all full of Christ, and all intended to point to Christ as our only Saviour. It is not only the law, which is a schoolmaster unto Christ, nor the types, which are shadows of Christ, nor yet the prophecies, which are predictions of Christ. Even where persons are not, events may be types. If any one failed to see in Isaac or in Joseph a personal type of Christ, he could not deny that the offering up of Isaac, or the selling of Joseph, and his making provision for the sustenance of his brethren, are typical of events in the history of our Lord. And so indeed every event points to Christ, even as He is alike the beginning, the centre, and the end of all history—‘the same yesterday, and to-day, and for ever.’ One thing follows from this: only that reading or study of the Scriptures can be sufficient or profitable through which we learn to know Christ—and that as ‘the Way, the Truth, and the Life’ to us. And for this purpose we ought constantly to ask the aid and teaching of the Holy Spirit.” (*Old Testament Bible History*, 2-3)

†2. **Elder Bruce D. Porter:** “More than 700 years before the birth of [Jesus Christ](#), Isaiah prophesied of Him in words memorialized by George Frideric Handel in The Messiah oratorio: “For unto us a child is born, unto us a son is given: and the government shall be upon his shoulder: and his name shall be called Wonderful, Counsellor, The mighty God, The everlasting Father, The Prince of Peace” ([Isaiah 9:6](#)). “Handel’s Messiah also brings to glorious musical life the following admonition, based on [Isaiah 40:9](#): “O thou that tellest good tidings to Zion, ... O thou that tellest good tidings to Jerusalem, lift up thy voice with strength; lift it up, be not afraid; say unto the cities of Judah, Behold your God!” (“[Come, Let Us Adore Him](#),” *Ensign*, Dec. 2013.)

†3. **Elder Bruce D. Porter:** “An ancient Hebrew tradition held that the Messiah would be born at Passover. We know that April in the meridian of time indeed fell in the week of the Passover feast—that sacred Jewish commemoration of Israel’s salvation from the destroying angel that brought death to the firstborn sons of Egypt. Each Israelite [family](#) that sacrificed a lamb and smeared its blood on the wooden doorposts of their dwelling was spared (see [Exodus 12:3–30](#)). Thirty-three years after Christ’s Passover birth, His blood was smeared on the wooden posts of a cross to save His people from the destroying angels of death and sin” (“[Come, Let Us Adore Him](#),” *Ensign*, Dec. 2013).

†4. **Elder Bruce D. Porter:** “The Passover feast may have been the reason there was no room at the inn for Mary and Joseph. The population of Jerusalem swelled by tens of thousands during Passover, forcing travelers to seek accommodations in outlying towns. Mary and Joseph went to Bethlehem, the home of Joseph’s forefathers, to fulfill the requirements of an imperial census ordered by Caesar Augustus. The requirement of the census allowed them to make their appearance in Bethlehem anytime during the year, but they likely chose the Passover season because the Mosaic law required all males to present themselves in Jerusalem at Passover.⁴ Because Bethlehem was virtually next door to the Holy City, the couple from Nazareth could take care of two obligations at once” (“[Come, Let Us Adore Him](#),” *Ensign*, Dec. 2013).

Recommended reading:

1. Elder Bruce D. Porter, “[Come Let Us Adore Him](#),” *Ensign*, Dec. 2013, 20.
2. President Dieter F. Uchtdorf, “[Can We See the Christ in Christmas?](#)” 2009 Christmas Devotional.
3. President Thomas S. Monson, “[The Spirit of the Season](#),” 2009 Christmas Devotional. In this talk, find and read the story about “[Gate 67](#)”.
4. President James E. Faust, First Presidency Message “[The Power of Peace](#),” *Ensign*, Dec. 2004. In this talk find and read the story of the [blind Japanese pastor in Nagasaki, Japan. He had survived the atom bomb](#).
5. Stephen E. Robinson, “[Believing Christ: A Practical Approach to the Atonement](#),” BYU Speeches, May 29, 1990.
6. “[Prophecies Jesus Fulfilled: 44 Prophecies of the Messiah Fulfilled in Jesus Christ](#),” at About.com, accessed 12/20/13.
7. “[Where does the Old Testament predict the coming of Christ?](#)” at gotQuestions.org, accessed 12/20/13.

Recommended media:

1. Web page with links: [Visit LDS.org for a More Christ-Centered Christmas](#).
2. Video: [The Reason Behind Christmas](#) (3:43).
3. Video: [The Nativity](#) (7:52).
4. Web Page with links: [Christmas](#). (Scroll down and browse the videos.)
5. Piano Guys Video: [O Come, Emmanuel](#) (5:27).

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†5. Elder Bruce D. Porter: “The innkeeper has come down in history as somewhat notorious. Yet given the crowding throughout the region during Passover, we can hardly blame him for having no room to offer the couple from Nazareth. While the majority of Passover pilgrims camped out in thousands of tents pitched on the plains around Jerusalem, thousands of others sought refuge in the local inns, known as caravansaries or khans. The Bethlehem inn was no doubt overflowing, and the innkeeper’s offering of the stable was likely an act of genuine kindness.

“Even had the couple found room in the inn, it would have offered only primitive accommodations. A typical khan of the period was a stone structure consisting of a series of small rooms, each with only three walls and open to public view on one side. The stable, however, was likely a walled courtyard or even a limestone cave, where animals belonging to the guests were kept.⁵ Whether in courtyard, cave, or other refuge, Christ’s birth among the animals did have one conspicuous advantage over the crowded interior of an inn: here at least were peace and privacy. In this sense, the offering of the stable was a blessing, allowing the most sacred birth in human history to take place in reverent solitude” (“[Come, Let Us Adore Him](#),” *Ensign*, Dec. 2013).

†6. President Dieter F. Uchtdorf: “Not being able to see the sacred either with the eyes or with the heart has been a fault of the human condition since the beginning. In the scriptures we read ‘For the things which some men esteem to be of great worth ... others set at naught and trample under their feet’ (1 Nephi 19:7). Sometimes the most precious and sacred things are right in front of us—in plain sight, so to speak—but we cannot or will not see them.

“This may be especially true during the blessed and precious season of Christmas. This is a beautiful time of the year. Trees are draped with lovely sparkling lights, the stores glitter with dazzling decorations, and the streets bustle with crowds of shoppers seeking gifts for those they love.

“All of these spectacular displays and decorations that compete for our attention can be beautiful and uplifting, but if that’s all we see, then we’re missing something that’s in plain sight. Sometimes, despite our best intentions, we become so preoccupied with responsibilities, commitments, and the stress of our many tasks that we fail to see with our hearts that which is essential and most sacred. (“[Can We See the Christ in Christmas?](#)” *Ensign*, Broadcasts, First Presidency Christmas Devotional 2009, accessed on 12/21/13.)

†7. President Dieter F. Uchtdorf: “Sometimes when we read about people who could not see the Savior for who He was, we marvel at their blindness. But do we also let distractions obstruct our view of the Savior—during this Christmas season and throughout the year? Some are external distractions—the gifts we worry about, the decorations, or the clamorous advertising—but often it is what is inside us that blinds us from seeing the Christ.

“Some may feel a certain level of intellectual aloofness that distances them from Christ. In an age when vast amounts of knowledge are at our fingertips, the familiar story of Jesus the Christ can get lost amid the flood of scientific advances, pressing news, or the latest popular movies or books.

“Some are so caught up in the details of running their lives that they don’t make time for much else. They might pay lip service to the things of the Spirit, but their hearts are so focused on the world that they cannot see the Christ.” (“[Can We See the Christ in Christmas?](#)” *Ensign*, Broadcasts, First Presidency Christmas Devotional 2009, accessed on 12/21/13.)

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